

Assigned Reading & Viewing

- (1) Excerpts from Historical Narratives ([read online](#), 6 pages)
- (2) Excerpts from Literature/Poetry ([link](#), 5 pages)
- (3) Images of artwork ([link](#), 5 pages)
- (4) Jolly, Priscilla. (2021). 'Godzilla vs. Kong': Monster movies evoke adventure but also 'dangers' of tropics. *The Conversation*. ([link](#); 4 pages)
- (5) Why Does Earth Have Deserts? ([link to video](#); 2 min)
- (6) BBC Planet Earth: Jungles. (2006). [link to video](#); requires login with Gatorlink, 51 min).
- (7) CBS News. (2023). Inside the Smithsonian's tropical forest lab. ([watch online](#), 5:35 min.)
- (8) Butler, Rhett. (2015). How many tree species are found in the world's rainforests? *Mongabay* ([read online](#), 5 min.)
- (9) Matthew Earl Boone and Mathieu Basille. Using iNaturalist to contribute your nature observations to science. UF EDIS Document WEC413 ([read online](#), 4 pages) and then familiarize yourself with iNaturalist at <https://www.inaturalist.org/>
- (10) Allington, Kristine, Michael Amundson, Linithd Aparicio, Caitlin Saks (Producers), and G. Townsley (Director). (2023). Ancient Builders of the Amazon. Public Broadcasting Service. ([watch online](#), 53 min.)
- (11) Hunt, Chris and Premathilake, Rathnasiri. (2018). Prehistoric people started to spread domesticated bananas across the world 6,000 years ago. *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 3 pages).
- (12) Anthony Bourdain's Parts Unknown: Congo (S1E8) (*watch online free on XUMO PLAY or PLEX*, 50 min).
- (13) Brooks, David. (2010). The Messiah Complex. *The New York Times*. ([read online](#), 1 page)

- (14) Louis Lucero. (2013). New Interactive Tool Helps Track Earth's Forests. *New York Times*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (15) Serkez, Yaryna. (2020). Every Place Under Threat. *New York Times*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (16) Devouring the Rain Forest. *Washington Post*. ([read online](#), 20 min read).
- (17) Searcey, Dionne with photographs by Ashley Gilbertson. (2022). Raft by Raft, a Rainforest Loses Its Trees *New York Times*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (18) Andreoni, Manuela, Blacki Migliozi, Pablo Robles and Denise Lu with photographs by Victor Moriyama. (2022). The Illegal Airstrips Bringing Toxic Mining to Brazil's Indigenous Land. *New York Times*. ([read online](#), 15 min read).
- (19) Mason, Margie & McDowell, Robin. (2020). Palm oil labor abuses linked to world's top brands, banks. *Associated Press*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (20) Lustgarten, Abrahm. (2018). Palm Oil Was Supposed to Help Save the Planet. Instead It Unleashed a Catastrophe. *New York Times*. ([read online](#), 20 min.)
- (21) BBC News: Amazon rainforest: 'Once it's gone, it's gone forever' - interview with Erika Berenguer. ([link to video](#), 3 min).
- (22) Pearce, Fred. (2018). Rivers in the Sky: How Deforestation Is Affecting Global Water Cycles. *Yale360*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (23) Henry Knight Lozano (2023) California and Florida grew quickly on the promise of perfect climates in the 1900s – today, they lead the country in climate change risks. *The Conversation*. [Link](#)
- (24) learn about the EN-ROADS simulator we will be using in class at this ([link to website](#), 15 min read). You can even start experimenting with it here: ([link to site](#)).
- (25) Dasgupta, Shreya. 2017 Does forest certification really work? *Mongabay* ([read online](#) 15 min.)
- (26) Gaworecki, Mike. (2017). Cash for conservation: Do payments for ecosystem services work? *Mongabay* ([read online](#) 15 min.)
- (27) Gaworecki, Mike. (2021). How effective is the EU's marquee policy to reduce the illegal timber trade? *Mongabay* ([read online](#) 15 min.)
- (28) Ryan, John Charles. (2018). Why the stinky durian really is the 'king of all fruits' / *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 10 min).
- (29) Weintraub, Karen. (2019). They're Smelly and Spiky, and They Need Bats to Pollinate Them. *New York Times*. ([read online](#), 5 min read).

- (30) Wharton, Rachel. (2020). How the Tip of Florida Became a Tropical-Fruit Paradise. *Atlas Obscura*. ([read online](#), 5 min read).
- (31) NPR’s Throughline Podcast (2022). There Will Be Bananas. [[listen online](#), 56 min].
- (32) Lawal, Shola. (2020). Our Endless Appetite For Chocolate Has Bitter Environmental Consequences. *Huffington Post*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (33) Mufson, Steven and Georges, Salwan. (2019). The trouble with chocolate. *Washington Post* ([read online](#) to see the amazing maps, pictures, and data visualizations).
- (34) Williams, Wyatt. (2021). How Your Cup of Coffee Is Clearing the Jungle. *New York Times*. ([read online](#), or listen to the audio version with the link at top of the article).
- (35) Carodenuto, Sophia. (2021). Chocolate fix: How the cocoa industry could end deforestation in West Africa. *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (36) Mary Gagen. 2024. The world’s business and finance sectors can do much more to reverse deforestation – here’s the data to prove it. *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 10 min).
- (37) Katrina Kosec et al. (2025) Forest loss in Malawi: how having women at the table affected debates and decisions about solutions. *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (38) *BBC World Service* (2020). Don’t underestimate what one person can do on their own: The man who grew his own rainforest. ([link to video](#), 5 min long).
- (39) Dasgupta, Shreya. (2017). Does community-based forest management work in the tropics? *Mongabay* ([read online](#), 15 min read).
- (40) Maclean, Ruth with additional reporting by Caleb Kabanda and photography by Nanna Heitmann. (2022). What do the protectors of Congo’s peatlands get in return?” *New York Times*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (41) Kimbrough, L. (2021). How settlers, scientists, and a women-led industry saved Brazil’s rarest primate”. *Mongabay* ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (42) Dasgupta, Shreya (with research by Annika Schlemm & Zuzana Burivalova). (2017). Do protected areas work in the tropics?” *Mongabay*. ([read online](#), 25 min read).
- (43) Matti Barthel et al. (2025) DRC’s plan for the world’s largest tropical forest reserve would be good for the planet: can it succeed? *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 10 min read).
- (44) Gaworecki, Mike. (2021). Is planting trees as good for the Earth as everyone says? *Mongabay* ([read online](#) 15 min.)
- (45) Medici, Patricia. (2015). The coolest animal you know nothing about...and how we can save it. *TED Fellows Talk*. ([link to video](#), 11:20 min long).

- (46) Robin Chazdon et al. (2021). Tropical forests can recover surprisingly quickly on deforested lands – and letting them regrow naturally is an effective and low-cost way to slow climate change. *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 10 min.).
- (47) Vittor, Amy, Gabriel Zorello Laporta, and Maria Anice Mureb Sallum. (2020). How deforestation helps deadly viruses jump from animals to humans. *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 15 min read).
- (48) UF EPI. (2024) Florida’s mosquitoes can make you sick: Here’s how to protect yourself. [read online](#), 10 min. read)
- (49) Kuchipudi, Suresh V. (2020). Why so many epidemics originate in Asia and Africa – and why we can expect more. *The Conversation*. ([read online](#), 10 min).